

Topic: Legal Obligations when discovering an unauthorized Backdoor during an Authorized Security Test

Introduction?

Ethical hacking and penetration testing are performed to identify security weakness in a system with proper authorization from the organization. During security, the ethical hacker has important legal and professional responsibilities. These responsibilities include preserving evidence, reporting the incident correctly, and cooperating with law enforcement if required.

What is a Backdoor?

A Backdoor is a hidden method that allows someone to access a computer system without following normal authentication procedures. Attackers often install backdoors after an attack. A backdoor may allow the attacker to steal data, modify files, monitor users or launch additional attacks.

Evidence Handling

When an unauthorized Backdoor is discovered the ethical hacker must handle all evidence carefully. The first responsibility is to avoid changing or deleting could destroy valuable evidence alert the attacker.

The ethical hacker should:

- Record the date and time when the backdoor was discovered.
- documents the exact location of the backdoor in the system.
- collect system logs, screenshots, network traffic, and the investigation.
- preserve the integrity of digital evidence by avoiding unnecessary modifications.
- Follow the organization incident response and evidence collection procedures.

Reporting Responsibilities:

The ethical hacker must immediately report the discovery to the authorized client or the organization's designated security team. The report should be factual, accurate and free from assumptions.

The report should include:

- description of the discovered Backdoor
- How the Backdoor was identified
- Evidence that suggest that attacker is still active
- Possible security risks to the organization
- System and data that may be affected
- immediate recommendation to contain the threat

Involvement of Law Enforcement:

Whether law enforcement becomes involved is generally the decision of the organization or system, if the evidence indicates a serious cyber crime, data breach, financial fraud. To appropriate authorities.

Importance of Chain of Custody

Chain of Custody refers to the documented process that records digital collected, handled, stored, transferred, on investigation.

- Prove that evidence has not been altered.
- Maintain the credibility of digital evidence.
- Support legal proceedings.
- Ensure accountability for everyone who handled the evidence

Conclusion:

Discovering an active unauthorized backdoors during an unauthorized penetration test is a serious situation that requires organized properly document and an unbroken chain of custody become essentials. By following legal and ethics guidelines as hacker the organization while supporting a lawful investigation